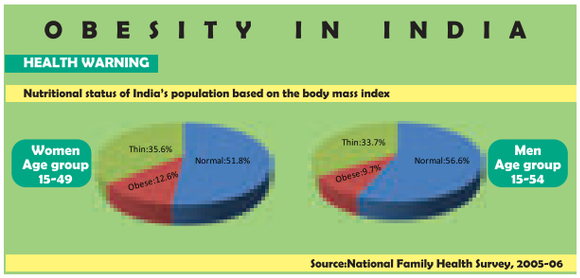
as "abnormal or excessive fat accumulation that may impair health". B



7.1.1 Aetiology

The factors causing obesity are given below:

Heredity: Heredity has a major role to play in obesity, as genes contribute to it. The involvement of genetic factors in the development of obesity is estimated to be 40-70%.

Physical Activity: Sedentary life style with lack of an exercise schedule tends to make one obese. Obesity is more common after the age of 35, when physical activity generally decreases without a corresponding decrease in food consumption.

Dietary Habits: Consuming high calorie food without burning off the calories leads to positive energy balance, which is one of the major contributory factor for obesity. Eating food at a very fast rate tend to chew less and lands up eating more food. Nibbling between meals may contribute extra calories leads to obesity.

Endocrine Factors: Endocrine abnormalities in conditions like hypothyroidism, Cushing's syndrome, polycystic ovarian syndrome is often associated with obesity.

Psychological Factors: Lonely, bored and depressed individuals find solace in piling on fast food and junk foods.

Affluence and Abundant availability of food: Eating out has become fashionable leading to an increased consumption of junk food which is rich in calories and short on essential nutrients.

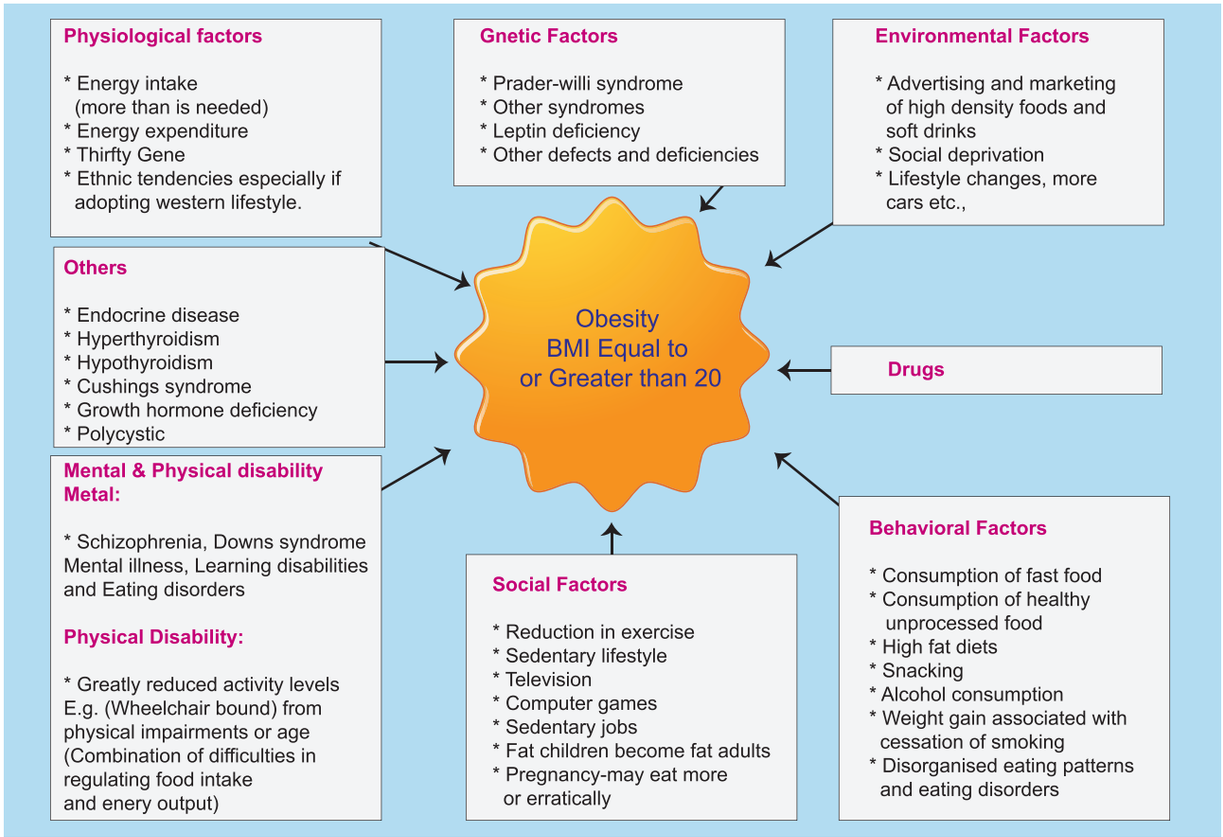


Fig 7.3 Factors causing obesity

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